PARACENTESIS: 50 IMPORTANT EXAM-BASED MCQs

Correct options are marked with ✓. Prepared from the uploaded Paracentesis lecture slides.

Topic source: Paracentesis PPTX lecture notes.

1. The peritoneal cavity is located between which two layers?

A. Pleura and pericardium
B. ✓ Parietal and visceral layers of peritoneum
C. Mucosa and serosa
D. Skin and fascia

2. Normally, the peritoneal cavity contains:

A. A large amount of blood
B. ✓ A small amount of lubricating fluid
C. Only air
D. No fluid at all

3. Normally, the peritoneal cavity is:

A. Always visible sonographically
B. ✓ A potential space not visible sonographically
C. Located inside the chest
D. Filled with urine

4. Intra-abdominal fluid usually moves to the lowest area due to:

A. Osmosis
B. ✓ Gravity
C. Peristalsis
D. Respiration only

5. The lowest areas where fluid collects are called:

A. Recessive sites
B. ✓ Dependent sites
C. Mobile sites
D. Fixed sites

6. In supine position, abdominal fluid commonly collects in the:

A. Anterior abdominal wall
B. ✓ Posterior parts of abdomen
C. Thoracic cavity
D. Urinary bladder

7. Morison's pouch is the:

A. ✓ Right subhepatic space
B. Left perihepatic space
C. Perisplenic space
D. Omental bursa

8. The right subhepatic space lies between the:

A. ✓ Liver and right kidney
B. Spleen and stomach
C. Diaphragm and lung
D. Bladder and uterus

9. The subphrenic space is located between the:

A. ✓ Diaphragm and liver
B. Kidney and bladder
C. Stomach and colon
D. Skin and muscle

10. The perisplenic space is the area around the:

A. Liver
B. ✓ Spleen
C. Kidney
D. Pancreas

11. Paracentesis is also called:

A. Pleural tap
B. ✓ Ascitic tap
C. Lumbar puncture
D. Pericardiocentesis

12. Paracentesis involves insertion of a needle or catheter into the:

A. Pleural cavity
B. ✓ Peritoneal cavity
C. Spinal canal
D. Urinary bladder

13. The fluid removed during paracentesis is:

A. ✓ Ascitic fluid
B. Cerebrospinal fluid
C. Synovial fluid
D. Pleural fluid only

14. Paracentesis is usually performed under guidance of:

A. X-ray only
B. ✓ Ultrasound
C. ECG
D. Endoscopy

15. The two main purposes of paracentesis are:

A. Preventive and surgical
B. ✓ Diagnostic and therapeutic
C. Obstetric and pediatric
D. Medical and radiological only

16. Diagnostic paracentesis is used for:

A. ✓ Fluid evaluation
B. Cosmetic reduction
C. Bone biopsy
D. Liver transplantation

17. Ascitic fluid evaluation helps differentiate:

A. ✓ Transudate and exudate
B. Artery and vein
C. Bone and muscle
D. Nerve and tendon

18. Transudative ascites is usually associated with conditions such as:

A. ✓ Liver cirrhosis or heart failure
B. Appendicitis only
C. Fracture
D. Asthma

19. Exudative fluid is usually due to:

A. ✓ Infection, inflammation, or cancer
B. Normal digestion
C. Simple dehydration
D. Normal pregnancy only

20. Detection of malignant cells is a diagnostic purpose of:

A. ✓ Paracentesis
B. Spirometry
C. ECG
D. Audiometry

21. Gram staining is performed to identify:

A. ✓ Bacteria
B. Platelet count
C. Bone density
D. Blood group

22. Microscopy and culture of ascitic fluid are used to detect:

A. ✓ Microorganisms causing infection
B. Only fetal cells
C. Lung volume
D. Cardiac rhythm

23. Therapeutic paracentesis is performed mainly to:

A. ✓ Remove large amounts of fluid
B. Insert a pacemaker
C. Correct vision
D. Treat fractures

24. Massive ascites can cause dyspnea by pushing the:

A. ✓ Diaphragm upward
B. Kidneys downward
C. Brain upward
D. Heart downward

25. Removing large ascitic fluid helps relieve:

A. ✓ Pressure symptoms
B. Hearing loss
C. Skin pigmentation
D. Bone pain only

26. Which is listed as a contraindication to paracentesis?

A. ✓ Acute abdomen
B. Mild headache
C. Normal bowel
D. Empty bladder

27. Coagulopathy is a contraindication especially when INR is:

A. ✓ > 2.0
B. < 1.0
C. Exactly 1.0
D. 0.5 only

28. Thrombocytopenia is a contraindication when platelet count is:

A. ✓ < 20 x 10 µL
B. > 200 x 10 µL
C. Normal
D. > 500 x 10 µL

29. Which local skin condition is a contraindication at the puncture site?

A. ✓ Cellulitis
B. Dry skin
C. Freckles
D. Scar-free skin

30. A distended urinary bladder is a contraindication because of risk of:

A. ✓ Bladder injury
B. Eye injury
C. Ear infection
D. Pneumonia

31. Distended bowel or massive ileus is avoided because it increases risk of:

A. ✓ Bowel injury
B. Hair loss
C. Hypertension only
D. Seizures

32. Intra-abdominal adhesions are important because they may increase risk during:

A. ✓ Paracentesis
B. Audiometry
C. ECG
D. Spirometry

33. Which item is part of paracentesis equipment?

A. ✓ Ultrasound machine
B. Ophthalmoscope
C. Laryngoscope only
D. Tuning fork

34. Specimen vials are needed for:

A. ✓ Cell count, Gram stain, and culture
B. Vision test
C. Hearing test
D. Bone scan

35. Needle size commonly used for diagnostic tap is approximately:

A. ✓ 1 mm diameter and 6-8 cm length
B. 5 mm diameter and 30 cm length
C. Only 30 G insulin needle
D. No needle is used

36. For therapeutic tap, larger caliber needles and catheters used are commonly:

A. ✓ 14-18 G
B. 30-32 G
C. 1-2 G
D. Only 25 G

37. Patient position for paracentesis may be:

A. ✓ Supine or left lateral oblique
B. Prone only
C. Standing on one leg
D. Trendelenburg only

38. If choosing the left lower quadrant, the patient may be placed in:

A. ✓ Left lateral oblique position
B. Right lateral only
C. Prone position only
D. Sitting cross-legged only

39. The ultrasound transducer commonly used is:

A. ✓ Curvilinear 2-5 MHz
B. Linear 15-20 MHz only
C. Transvaginal probe only
D. TEE probe

40. Before puncture, the operator should note the position of:

A. ✓ Bowel, mesentery, and bladder
B. Teeth and tongue
C. Ear canal
D. Retina

41. The depth from skin to ascites is measured using:

A. ✓ Ultrasound calipers or depth gauge
B. Thermometer
C. Stethoscope
D. Pulse oximeter

42. After the puncture site is marked, the patient should:

A. ✓ Remain in the same position
B. Walk around
C. Change position repeatedly
D. Stand immediately

43. An adequate fluid collection for paracentesis is usually at least:

A. ✓ 3-4 cm deep
B. 0.5 cm deep
C. 10-12 cm always
D. No fluid depth needed

44. The needle angle recommended in the slides is:

A. ✓ 60-90 degrees to the skin
B. 5 degrees to the skin
C. 180 degrees to the skin
D. Parallel only

45. A listed success rate for ultrasound-guided paracentesis is about:

A. ✓ 95%
B. 25%
C. 50%
D. 5%

46. Ascitic fluid leakage after paracentesis occurs in about:

A. ✓ 5%
B. 50%
C. 25%
D. 0% always

47. Which is a complication of paracentesis?

A. ✓ Bleeding/hematoma
B. Cataract
C. Deafness
D. Hyperthyroidism

48. Abdominal visceral injury in paracentesis commonly concerns injury to:

A. ✓ Bladder and bowel
B. Brain and spinal cord
C. Ear and nose
D. Eye and retina

49. Post-procedure hypotension may occur due to:

A. ✓ Excessive fluid loss
B. Excessive oxygen
C. Increased calcium
D. Overeating

50. A vascular complication listed is:

A. ✓ Inferior epigastric artery aneurysm
B. Carotid stenosis only
C. Retinal artery occlusion
D. Pulmonary embolism only